

Creative Strategy: Instagram Stories

March 2020

Introduction

We've created this report and guide to help DIV Brands take advantage of the Instagram successes we've seen from others and tap into more profitable placements and audiences.

The following was compiled with Facebook and tailored for DIV Brands:

1. Using Stories placement
 - a) Instagram Stories Best Practices
 - b) Recommended video editing apps
 - c) Bringing interactivity to Instagram Stories ads
2. General creative recommendations

Instagram Stories Best Practices

Instagram Stories ads still have low competition and high return when set up correctly as part of your ads funnel.

Engagement rates are high, but it's important to note this is the very top of the AIDA funnel, in driving Attraction into your funnel.

For DIV Brands, it's worth working on high contrast creatives, explosive colors and lifestyle, UGC shots.

Not only do customers care about the functionality of your products but also the style.



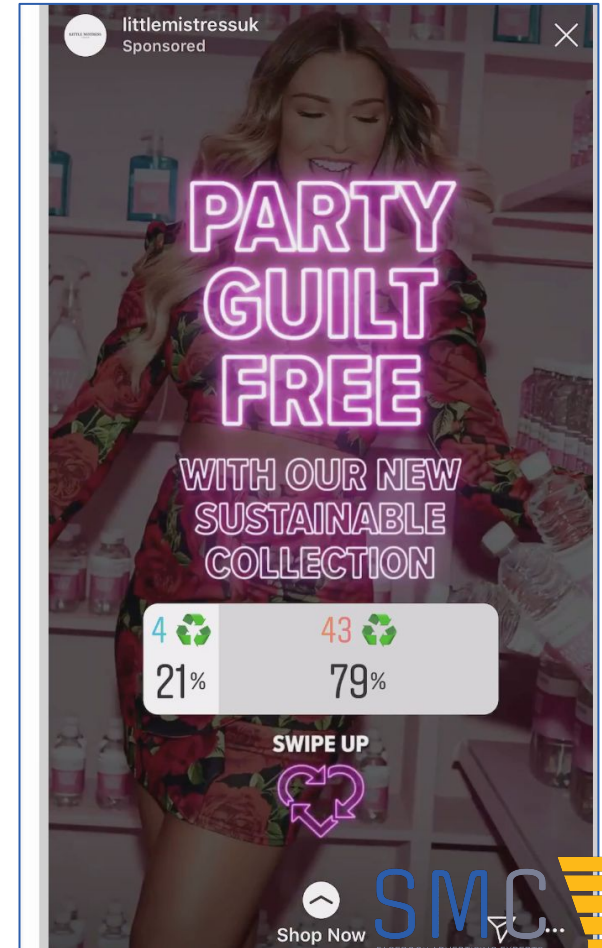
Instagram Stories Best Practices

Your main goal with story format ads should be to capture people's attention quickly by utilizing moving text, video footage, and fast transitions. Be specific and use engaging headlines.

Recommended video length: 15 seconds. It doesn't necessarily mean you have to only have one 15 second video - sometimes having a series of 15 second videos can make for a cool and fun way to showcase your brand or product's story.

We recommend adding a CTA that is custom made, engaging and appears in the first 3 seconds of a video along the regular one.

The Stories format is still new so users need to be told what to do.



Additional Creative Considerations For Stories



USE SPEED

as a creative tool

Speed is a creative feature, not a hurdle. In addition to how quickly people are moving through feed-based content, we also know that people consume content even more quickly in Stories.



MULTIPLE

scenes work better

Multiple scenes may increase effectiveness. For more complex stories, quick, multiple "chapters" lead to more effective campaigns.



SOUND

adds relevance

Sound adds richness to a story, and it may also be a factor in delivering greater relevance score.



BOOKEND

with brand

Opportunities exist to support brand recall at the finish line. Stories ads that had end cards performed better among audiences who had seen the ad in its entirety.



PLAY

more

With stories, you'll need to be creative. From shorter ads to disappearing stories, these new formats are evolving the game on mobile.

Other Recommendations

APPROACH

1. **Create for Stories-first:** Facebook recommends full screen vertical design made specifically for the Stories medium, but you can also repurpose an asset from another placement. If you choose to repurpose an existing asset, make sure not to remove important information through cropping or zooming.
2. **Enhance with motion :** Ads that use motion perform better. Consider adding motion to your static images.
3. **Test mobile shots depending on your objective :** In multiple tests, Facebook found that mobile shots outperform studio shots for ad recall and intent, while studio shots tend to drive higher brand awareness.

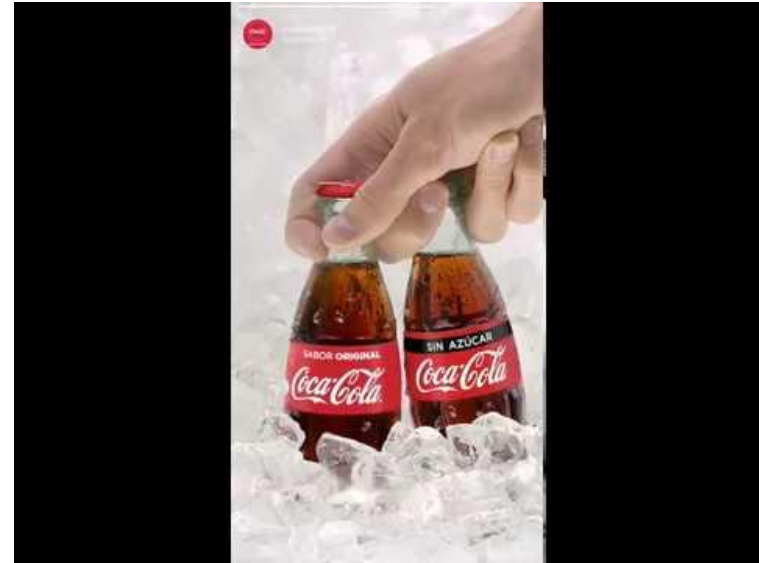
BRANDING

1. **Begin with your brand :** Facebook has found that ads with the best performance tend to put their key messages at the start of the creative. Put your logos or brand elements at the start of the video.
2. **Design with your objective in mind :** Your ad will perform better if you design your creative around your objective. If you use a brand objective, focus your ad on people. If you use a conversion objective, focus on products.
3. **Limit price inclusion :** Ads that don't include specific prices perform better for purchases and brand awareness.

Other Recommendations

FORMAT & EXECUTION

1. **Pair text with focal point** : Ads that include centrally located text, such as “add to cart,” at a specific focal point are helpful in driving conversion metrics.
2. **Avoid unnecessary stickers** : Stickers can be a great way to draw attention to your product and let your ad feel natural. However, stickers can also draw attention away from the product and feel inconsistent. Don't use unnecessary stickers that look unnatural or clutter your creative.
3. **Call your audience to action strategically** : Your call-to-action (CTA) drives viewers to take actions on your ad. Emphasize the action you want your audience to take, such as “swipe up” or “shop here.”
4. **Land takeaways with text overlays** : When using text overlays in Stories, consider carefully what method works best with your creative. Use text to emphasize key messages, but keep your focus on one point.



The example to the right shows some of the strategies being used 👉

Recommended video editing apps

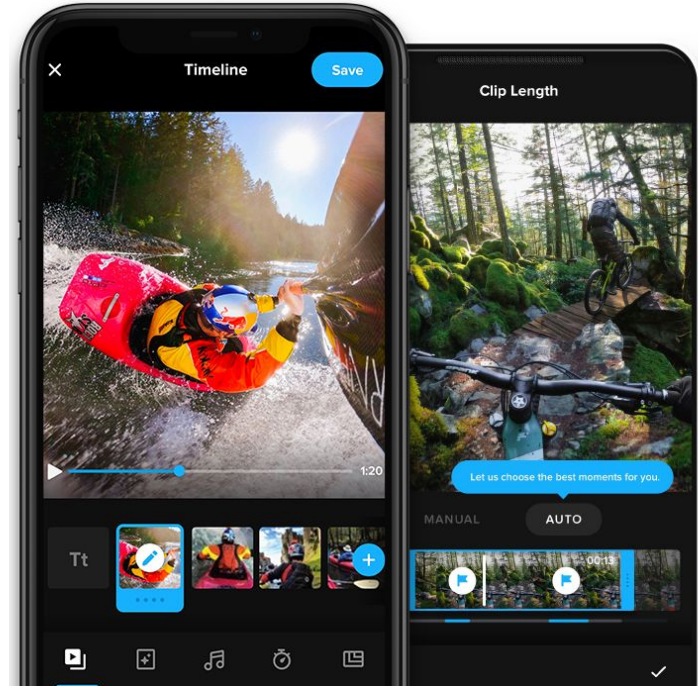
While there are thousands to choose from, we find the following apps to be the most user-friendly & recommended to create Instagram Stories - it doesn't have to cost much or take long to do:

Mobile

1. Legend
2. Quik
3. PlotaVerse
4. LumaFusion

Desktop

1. [Magisto](#)
2. [Shakr](#) (official partner of Facebook)



Bringing interactivity to Instagram Stories ads

Interactivity is a great way of building engagement and connecting with your target user. Polls in particular allow you to generate engagement top of funnel, especially useful for launches and promotions.

Creating an interactive stories ad is simple. In Ads Manager, choose Instagram Stories as your only ad placement. Then, where you upload your creative and edit your ad's text, tick the box Add an interactive poll. Try out the polling sticker to co-create a product, spark a conversation with your community, crowd source insights for product development, gamify your ad or run a contest!

For DIV Brands, this could be a great opportunity to hear people's opinions by allowing them to vote or engaging with questions based on various angles/pain points.

Inspiration:

1. <https://business.instagram.com/success/little-mistress/>
2. <https://business.instagram.com/success/reserved/>



General creative recommendations

- **VIDEO FORMAT: 4:5 (1080x1350)**

Why? Mobile optimization. Nearly 80% of all ads are viewed on mobile. 4:5 is 25% taller than 1:1 (square), meaning it takes up more screen increasing click through rates.

- **VIDEO LENGTH: Less than 30 seconds**

Typically results in cheaper CPMs, and higher CTRs in a large variety of industries.

- **STYLE: Clean and crisp**

Have clear CTAs, speak to pain points but have brand voice. Bright colors and quick cuts also help.

- **STATIC FORMAT: 1:1**

Facebook wants to crop most 4:5 static creatives to square. We've seen brands running Dynamic Creative having their content cropped unknowingly.

- **STATIC STYLE: Simple. Less is more**

Clean and bright backgrounds with good contrast are absolutely great, arguably better than videos for prospecting. Don't be afraid to play with colors.

Next Steps

We're here to help!

We can either help with ideas or for you to bounce ideas off on how to use this within your account funnel.

Feel free to reach out to us, share your ideas or for us to feedback on ads ready to go live.

Compiled by SMC & Facebook on behalf of DIV Brands.